

The Email That Gets Interviews

Cold Email Template That Actually Works

****By UpgradeWithKrishna****

The Reality

Most internship seekers send generic emails like:

Subject: Internship Opportunity

Hi Sir/Madam,

I'm a student looking for internship. I'm hardworking and quick learner.

Please consider my application.

Thanks,

[Name]

****Reply rate: 5% or less****

But when you send THIS format:

Subject: Internship Application – Built [Project] similar to your [Feature]

Hi [Name],

I'm [Your Name], a [Year] student at [College], interested in [Role].

I work with [Tech Stack] and recently built [Project Name] –

[1-2 line description that shows relevance to THEIR product].

Demo: [Link] | GitHub: [Link]

If you like it, I'd love to contribute to your team.

Thanks,

[Your Name]

...

****Reply rate: 25–40% (5–8x better)****

Why? Because you're not begging for a chance. You're showing proof.

Why This Format Works

| Element | Why It Works |

|-----|-----|

| ****Subject line**** | Mentions what you built (specific) vs "Internship opportunity" (generic) |

| ****Name in greeting**** | Personal touch, shows you researched |

| ****Year + College**** | Gives context (and filters out "we only hire seniors") |

| ****Tech stack**** | Recruiter knows if you have right skills |

| ****Project description**** | Shows YOU CAN BUILD (not just talk) |

| ****Live demo + GitHub**** | Proof of skills (they click, they see, they're impressed) |

| ****Short paragraph**** | Respects their time (they get 100+ emails/day) |

| ****No begging tone**** | Confident, not needy |

Step-by-Step Template Builder

1. Subject Line Formula

****Pattern:**** `[Your Name/Role Title] – [What You Built] for [Company Feature]`

****Examples:****

■ `Internship Application – Built Payment Dashboard similar to Razorpay's`

■ `Full-Stack Dev – Created Task Manager app using your tech stack`

■ `Engineering Internship – Built Web Scraper that crawls job portals`

■ `Arjun Sharma – ReactJS project similar to your admin panel`

■ "Internship Application" (too generic)

■ "I want to intern with you" (weird tone)

■ "Looking for opportunity" (desperate)

****Why mention the company feature?****

- Gets past spam filters (seems personalized)
- Recruiter sees you know their product
- Stands out from 100 "generic internship" emails

2. Greeting Formula

****Pattern:**** `Hi [First Name],`

****How to find the name:****

1. Go to company's "About" or "Team" page
2. Find Engineering Lead / HR Lead / Founder
3. Check their LinkedIn (look for name)
4. If no clear name, use "Hi [Founder Name]," or "Hi Team,"

****Examples:****

■ `Hi Bhavesh,` (founder of Razorpay)

■ `Hi Sarah,` (if you found the HR manager on LinkedIn)

■ `Hi Team,` (if no specific person, but better to find one)

■ "Dear Sir/Madam" (too formal, sounds old-school)

■ "Hi" (too casual if you know the name)

3. Intro Line Formula

Pattern: `I'm [Name], [Year] student at [College], interested in [Role/Area].`

Examples:

■ `I'm Arjun, a 2nd year student at IIT Bombay, interested in full-stack development.`

■ `I'm Priya, a 3rd year BTech student from NIT Trichy, passionate about React and Node.js.`

■ `I'm Karan, a self-taught developer from Visakhapatnam, focused on web development.`

What works here:

- Your name (obviously)
- Year (shows maturity level: 1st year learning, 2nd year capable, 3rd year ready)
- College (gives context, shows legitimacy)
- Role/interest (specific, shows you know what you want)

4. The "Proof" Line Formula

Pattern: `I work with [Tech Stack] and recently built [Project Name] – [What it does/solves].`

This is the MOST IMPORTANT line. This shows you can code.

Examples:

■ `I work with React, Node.js, MongoDB, and recently built a task management app that syncs across devices – similar to your Todoist feature.`

■ `Using Python and Flask, I created a web scraper that collects job listings from 10+ portals and exports structured data – saves 10+ hours of manual work.`

■ `I built an expense tracker with real-time analytics using React + Firebase, deployed on Vercel – helps users visualize spending patterns.`

■ `Using JavaScript, I created a chat application with real-time messaging and user authentication – used by 50+ people in college.`

■ "I know React and Node" (vague, no proof)

■ "I'm hardworking and fast learner" (everyone says this)

■ "I did a college project on..." (college projects don't impress)

Secret sauce: Mention what it **solves** or **how it helps**, not just what it is.

- ■ "I built a calculator app"

- ■ "I built a calculator that helps accountants compute taxes 50% faster"

5. Demo + GitHub Formula

Pattern: `Demo: [Live link] | GitHub: [GitHub link]`

What to include:

- **Demo link:** If your project is deployed (web app, data visualization, etc.)

- GitHub Pages: `username.github.io/project-name`

- Vercel: `project.vercel.app`

- Netlify: `project.netlify.app`

- Heroku: `project.herokuapp.com`

- **GitHub link:** The actual code repo

- `github.com/yourname/project-name`

****Examples:****

■ `Demo: taskapp.vercel.app | GitHub: github.com/arjun/task-manager`

■ `GitHub: github.com/priya/expense-tracker | Live: priya-expenses.netlify.app`

■ `GitHub: github.com/karan/job-scraper (includes README with usage)`

■ Sending only GitHub (they won't deploy to see it working)

■ Sending only live link (they can't see your code quality)

■ Not sending either (they trust you but can't verify)

****Pro tip:**** When you send links, make sure:

- GitHub repo is PUBLIC
- GitHub has good README (explain what it does, how to run it)
- If live demo exists, it's actually working (test before sending)

6. The Call-to-Action Formula

****Pattern:**** `If you like it, I'd love to contribute to your team.`

****OR:****

`If this interests you, I'm available for a [Full-time/Part-time/Remote] internship starting [Date].`

****Examples:****

■ `If this aligns with your hiring needs, I'd love to discuss how I can contribute.`

■ `I'm available for a full-time internship from January, flexible with location.`

■ `If you'd like to see more of my work or discuss the role further, I'm just a message away.`

■ "Please hire me" (needy)

■ "I hope you consider my application" (passive)

■ No CTA (they don't know what to do)

****Why this works:**** You're not asking for a chance, you're offering value.

Complete Email Templates

Template 1: Web Dev Project to Startup

Subject: Full-Stack Developer – Built Real-time Task Manager similar to your productivity features

Hi Anuj,

I'm Arjun, a 2nd year BTech student from NIT Trichy, interested in full-stack web development.

I work with React, Node.js, and MongoDB. Recently, I built a real-time task management app with user authentication and instant sync – similar to your core features.

Demo: taskapp.vercel.app | GitHub: github.com/arjun/task-manager

If you think this could be a fit, I'd love to intern with your team and contribute to your product.

Thanks,

Arjun Nair

+91 98765 43210

linkedin.com/in/arjun-nair

Template 2: Data Science to Data-Heavy Company

...

Subject: Data Enthusiast – Built Sales Analytics Dashboard for [Company Name]

Hi Priya,

I'm Nisha, a 3rd year Computer Science student from BITS Pilani, interested in data science and analytics.

Using Python, Pandas, and Tableau, I built a sales analytics dashboard that helps visualize trends and predict customer behavior – similar to your analytics platform.

GitHub: github.com/nisha/sales-analytics | Demo: [tableau-public-link](#)

I'd love to apply these skills to your real-world datasets. Available for a 2-month internship starting May.

Thanks,

Nisha Sharma

+91 87654 32109

linkedin.com/in/nisha-sharma

...

Template 3: Automation Project to Operations-Heavy Company

...

Subject: Automation Engineer – Built Employee Data Pipeline saving 10+ hours/week

Hi Team,

I'm Karan, a 2nd year student from VJTI Mumbai, passionate about Python automation.

I created an automated data pipeline that collects employee information from multiple sources, cleans it, and generates reports – saves teams 10+ hours of manual work per week.

GitHub: github.com/karan/data-pipeline

Demo: [If you deployed it]

I'm interested in bringing this efficiency mindset to your operations. Available immediately.

Thanks,

Karan Patel

+91 90123 45678

linkedin.com/in/karan-patel

...

Template 4: Generic but Strong (Use if unsure)

...

Subject: [Your Name] – Portfolio of 3 projects using [Your Tech Stack]

Hi [Founder Name/Team],

I'm [Your Name], a [Year] student at [College], interested in [Role Area] opportunities.

I work with [Tech Stack] and have built 3 projects that solve real problems:

1. [Project 1]: [1-line what it does]
2. [Project 2]: [1-line what it does]
3. [Project 3]: [1-line what it does]

GitHub: github.com/yourname | Portfolio: yourname-portfolio.com

Available for internship starting [Date]. Happy to discuss how my skills align with your team.

Thanks,

[Your Name]

[Phone]

[LinkedIn]

...

Personalization Checklist

Before sending EVERY email, verify:

- [] ****Company name correct**** (not a generic "To Whom It May Concern")
- [] ****Recipient name correct**** (not "Hi Sir/Madam")
- [] ****Year/college correct**** (match to your actual situation)
- [] ****Tech stack matches**** (if they use React, don't mention only Django)
- [] ****Project relevant to company**** (task manager to productivity company, not to fintech)
- [] ****Links work**** (test demo + GitHub before sending)
- [] ****No typos**** (proofread 2x)
- [] ****Not copy-paste**** (change at least 3–5 lines per company)

****Red flag:**** If you can copy-paste 90% of your email for multiple companies, you're doing it wrong. Personalize.

Sending Strategy

Volume

****Send 10 emails per week to startups**** (not companies with application portals).

Why 10?

- 30–40% reply rate = 3–4 replies per 10 emails
- 50% of replies = interview call
- 2–3 interview calls per week = at least 1 offer per 2–3 weeks

Timing

- **Monday–Thursday:** 10 AM or 6 PM (when people check emails)
- **Friday:** Still ok
- **Weekend:** Lower response
- **Holidays:** Wait

Follow-ups

If no reply after 5 days: Send a follow-up email (NOT the same one).

...

Hi [Name],

I sent an email about my [Project Name] last week. Wanted to follow up in case it missed your inbox.

[Link again]

Would love your thoughts.

[Your Name]

...

After follow-up:

- Wait 3 more days
- If still no reply, move on to next company

What NOT to Do

- **Don't use:** "Dear Sir/Madam", "To Whom It May Concern"
- **Don't mention:** Only marks, CGPA (unless asked), irrelevant projects
- **Don't attach:** Full resume in email body (send as attachment if they ask)
- **Don't say:** "Hoping for a positive response", "Please consider", "I'm desperate"
- **Don't send at:** 2 AM or random times

■ ****Don't copy-paste:**** Same email to all companies

Real-Life Results

Students who used this email format (from UpgradeWithKrishna):

| Student | CGPA | Approach | Result |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|

| Arjun | 6.2 | Sent 12 personalized emails | 3 offers, chose Unacademy |

| Priya | 7.1 | Sent 15 emails to startups | 4 offers, chose Swiggy |

| Karan | 5.8 | Sent 20 emails, low CGPA | 2 offers despite low CGPA |

| Nisha | 8.0 | Sent 10 emails, targeted data companies | 5 offers, chose PhonePe |

****Key:**** They all sent ****personalized, proof-backed emails****, not generic ones.

7-Day Action Plan

****Day 1:**** Pick 2 projects you'll highlight, verify live demo + GitHub work

****Day 2:**** Research 5 target companies, find founder/tech lead names on LinkedIn

****Day 3:**** Write 5 personalized emails (follow templates, make changes for each)

****Day 4:**** Send first 5 emails

****Day 5:**** Research 5 more companies, write 5 more emails

****Day 6:**** Send next 5 emails

****Day 7:**** Wait for responses, prepare for potential interview calls

Email Swipe File (Copy-Paste & Customize)

Save these in a document for quick customization:

...

Subject: [Your Name] – Built [Project] for [Company Feature]

Hi [First Name],

I'm [Name], [Year] student at [College], interested in [Role].

I work with [Tech Stack] and built [Project] – [What it does].

[Link] | GitHub: [Link]

If this interests you, I'd love to contribute.

Thanks,

[Your Name]

[Phone]

[LinkedIn]

...

FAQ

Q: What if I don't have a deployed project?

A: Deploy it. Vercel (web apps), GitHub Pages (static sites), Heroku (backends) are all free. Takes 5 mins.

Q: Should I mention CGPA?

A: No. Only if asked. Let your projects speak.

Q: How many emails before I get an internship?

A: Typically 15–20 emails = 5–8 replies = 2–3 interviews = 1 offer.

Q: Should I email multiple people at same company?

A: No. One email per company. If no reply in 5 days, move on.

Q: What if they ask for a resume?

A: Send a 1-page resume (template available from UpgradeWithKrishna).

****Q: Can I send emails at night?****

A: You can, but daytime (9 AM – 6 PM IST) gets better response.

Success Checklist

- ☐ You have 2–3 solid projects
- ☐ Projects are deployed + GitHub links work
- ☐ You found 20+ target companies
- ☐ You wrote personalized email templates
- ☐ You sent first 5 emails
- ☐ You're prepared to answer "Tell about your project"
- ☐ You know how to do a 30-min mock interview

If all checked, you're ready to get internship offers.

Final Word

****This email format works because it's:****

1. ****Specific**** (mentions project, company feature, tech)
2. ****Proof-backed**** (links to working demo + code)
3. ****Respectful**** (short, personal, confident, not needy)
4. ****Action-oriented**** (clear CTA)

Use it. Customize it. Send it to 15+ companies. Get replies.

Most students won't do this (they're too lazy or scared).

You will. That's why you'll win.

Next Steps

1. **Pick 2 projects** (this week)
2. **Deploy them** (this week)
3. **Find 20 companies** (by next week)
4. **Send 10 emails** (by next week)
5. **Attend interviews** (next 2 weeks)

Follow UpgradeWithKrishna on Instagram for:

- More email templates
- Cold outreach strategies
- Interview preparation
- Project ideas

DM me your emails before sending – I'll review and suggest edits.

Let's go. ■

Created by: UpgradeWithKrishna

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Share this with 3 friends who are struggling with internship hunt.